Preparing for Your Phone Interview

Ways to Prepare

Job Description: Familiarize yourself with the job description of the position for which you're applying. You can find yours in this external link.

Leadership Principles: Familiarize yourself with our company's Leadership Principles. Most of the interview questions you will be asked are derivatives of our Leadership Principles, so you may be well served to review these in depth. Come up with a couple examples of your work that exemplify each Leadership Principle.

Data: Amazon is a data-driven company. We love to hear about metrics and data that you've used to make decisions and measure results. Make sure to prepare to talk about the impact of your work using numbers.

Leadership: Leaders should be able to provide examples of leading, teaching, training, influencing, and facilitating the development of your team and peers.

Questions: It is important to ask high scope questions with each interviewer. It goes a long way when you've taken the initiative to research the company prior to your interview and prepared thoughtful questions that will help you understand the company and the role.

Why Amazon: We want to hire smart, passionate people. Please reflect on what motivated you to pursue a career with Amazon and be prepared to speak to it. Although "Why Amazon?" is a standard type of question, we genuinely want to understand what inspired you to explore an opportunity with us.

Articles to Review

1. Scale/Scope of Amazon Web Services
2. Working at Amazon
3. Amazon is the cloud
4. World's most innovative companies
5. AWS re:Invent
6. Amazon Glassdoor Interview Reviews

STAR Format

The **STAR** method is a structured manner of responding to a **behavioral-based interview question** by discussing the specific situation, task, action, and result of the situation you are describing. Remember, we want to know what you did, not what your team did.

Situation: Describe the situation that you were in or the task that you needed to accomplish. You must describe a specific event or situation, not a generalized description of what you have done in the past. Be sure to give enough detail for the interviewer to understand. This situation can be from a previous job, from a volunteer experience, or any relevant event.

Task: What goal were you working toward?

Action: Describe the actions you took to address the situation with an appropriate amount of detail and keep the focus on YOU. What specific steps did you take and what was your particular contribution? Be careful that you don't describe what the team or group did when talking about a project, but what you actually did. Use the word "I," not "we" when describing actions.

Result: Describe the outcome of your actions and don't be shy about taking credit for your behavior. What happened? How did the event end? What did you accomplish? What did you learn? Make sure your answer contains multiple positive results. In addition, be sure to use metrics to show your results and be able to provide solid data to back that up.

Make sure that you follow all parts of the STAR method. ***Be as specific as possible*** *at all times, without rambling or including too much information. Also, eliminate any examples that do not paint you in a positive light. However, keep in mind that some examples you may provide that touch on a negative results (such as "lost the game") can highlight your strengths in the face of adversity.*

amazon web services